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Gate-keeper rifle holder

Abstract

A firearm attachment and method for transport implementing a receiver plate affixed permanently, semi-permanently, or removably to tactical, or non-tactical clothing items or accessories. The receiver plate has one or more apertures with means of latching, claspings, or otherwise grasping by way of a fork, pin, keyhole, or other geometry that may cause an interference fit with an insertion pin, post, or other appendage. The insertion post may be a modified or re-purposed take-down pin that is a modification or improvement of a component already existing on a firearm. A insertion post may also be affixed to an accessory aperture or other device, existing on or mounted on a firearm or on accessories mounted to the firearm.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application claims priority to and the benefit of U.S. provisional patent application Ser. No. 63/353,821, filed 20 Jun. 2022, the contents of which are incorporated herein in their entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) Strap type slings for Rifles and Long guns have been beneficial since the first long gun was introduced in the 13^{sup}.th century. The sling aids the arms carrier in transporting the rifle and/or long gun over different types of terrain and in various environments.

(2) More recently, with the introduction of modern battle rifles and sporting guns of all shapes, sizes and designs, a wider variety of modern gun slings have been developed to make the carrying or transporting long guns for extended periods of time such as might occur on hunting expeditions, military patrolling operations, and even stationary guard duty scenarios, more comfortable for the user.

(3) Slings are typically separated into the classifications of single point (of attachment) or two-

point (of attachment) slings.

(4) These slings generally attach to an attachment point on the fore end, a mid point attachment, and/or the butt end of a long gun and allow the gun to be carried and supported by a strap either over the user's shoulder, or routed around the user's neck.

(5) With wider use of specialized equipment vests and plate carriers, (which are a ballistics vest/equipment vest hybrids) by law enforcement, military, and civilians, new methods of supporting long guns are needed.

(6) The M16 rifle, invented in in the late 1950's, and the many variations or derivatives that have been developed since, have all historically utilized the same strap sling carrying methodology.

(7) Due to the Military Specifications on standardization, (mil-spec standardization) of rifles that follow the original M16 platform, and other firearms platforms that have adapted similar standardization within their business model, designing support systems for specific families of firearms is necessary.

SUMMARY

(8) One aspect of the present disclosure relates to a mounting device comprising a housing having two housing apertures; and a capture interface having two spaced apart latching apertures aligned with the two housing apertures and wherein the capture interface is moveable within the housing and the latching apertures are configured to receive and couple to one or more insertion posts to secure a first end of the insertion posts to the mounting device.

(9) The capture interface is a spring biased receiver plate wherein the capture interface is moveable between a first position and a second position wherein in the first position a first portion of the latching apertures are exposed and configured to receive the first end of the insertion post therein and wherein in the second position a second portion of the latching apertures are exposed and configured to hold the end of the insertion post therein.

(10) The insertion posts are extensions, modifications, or specialized versions of takedown pins for a firearm.

(11) A second end of the insertion posts are appendages attached to a firearm, a mounted firearm accessory, or firearm assembly components which have been modified to serve a purpose on the firearm, and as a means of attaching the firearm to the receiver plate.

(12) The takedown pins comprise an o-ring, retaining ring, retaining pin, or bushing for aiding attachment of the pin to an object or accessory such as a firearm.

(13) The housing is configured for fixedly or removably attaching to clothing, accessories, or backpacks.

(14) The insertion posts are fixedly or removably attached to available accessory mounting geometry on a firearm or an attachable firearm accessory.

(15) The housing comprises one or more funneled features surrounding each housing aperture for guiding each insertion post into the corresponding latching aperture on the capture interface.

(16) The insertion posts are slotted for use with a fork type locking mechanism.

(17) The insertion posts comprise holes for retention by pins inserted either manually or mechanically there through.

(18) The receiver plate is comprised of metal, alloy, composite plastic, carbon fiber, or combinations thereof.

(19) The latching apertures comprise one or more latching features that mate with insertion pins, posts, or appendages.

(20) A lever on the housing is a release lever that is moveable to move the capture device between the first and second positions.

(21) Yet another aspect of the present disclosure relates to a receiver mount comprising a receiver plate body; and one or more connection mechanisms on the plate body and configured to receive an insertion pin or an adapter pin for supporting a device on the receiver plate body, wherein the one or more connection mechanisms each comprises a receiver hitch latching aperture for receiving and

removably coupling to a corresponding end of the insertion post or adapter pin.

(22) An adapter plate having a plurality of apertures spaced apart thereon is configured to couple to an opposing end of the adapter pin such that one or more adapter pins secure the adapter plate to the receiver plate body which is then also securing to the device for coupling the device to the receiver mount.

(23) The device is a firearm or firearm accessory.

(24) The insertion post is a first insertion post and further comprising a second insertion post wherein first ends of the first and second insertion posts are each coupled to the receiver hitch latching aperture of a corresponding connection mechanism and second ends of the first and second insertion posts are each coupled to the device, a firearm, a mounted firearm accessory, or firearm assembly component.

(25) The one or more connection mechanisms comprises tapered or funneled surfaces surrounding an aperture in the receiver plate body which is aligned with the receiver hitch latching aperture and exposes the receiver hitch latching aperture and wherein the receiving hitch latching aperture is moveable in reciprocal direction while the receiver mount aperture remains stationary.

(26) Yet another aspect of the present disclosure relates to a method for mounting a device onto a receiver mount comprising coupling a receiver plate body to clothing or equipment; moving a receiver plate within the receiver plate body to a first position; inserting a terminal end of one or more insertion posts secured to the device into one or more corresponding latching apertures in the receiver plate body; releasing a latch on the receiver plate body to move the receiver plate to a second position for latching the one or more insertion posts therein; and retaining the device on the receiver mount.

(27) The device is a firearm and the one or more insertion posts comprise takedown pins mounted on or otherwise secured to the firearm and protruding from the firearm.

(28) The takedown pins comprise factory original takedown pins for the firearm, modified takedown pins installed on the firearm, or combinations thereof.

(29) Yet another aspect of the present disclosure relates to an insertion post comprising a shaft terminating in a head and a midpoint radial slot, a capture geometry, and an extended length, wherein the capture geometry comprises an o-ring, retaining ring, retaining pin, or bushing configured to allow the extended length to couple to a takedown pin aperture on a firearm and prevent the shaft from being driven into the aperture on the firearm.

(30) The insertion post is a take-down pin and is configured to couple to one or both of a receiver mount for a firearm or an adapter plate for the receiver mount for the firearm. The extended length of the insertion post is at least approximately $\frac{3}{4}$ inches.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a front perspective view of a holder assembly according to one or more embodiments described herein.

(2) FIG. 2 is a rear view thereof.

(3) FIGS. 3A and 3B are front and rear views of a receiver plate of the holder assembly.

(4) FIG. 4 is a front view showing the firearm holder assembly and receiver plate as mounted therein.

(5) FIG. 5 is a side view of the device illustrated in FIG. 4.

(6) FIGS. 6A and 6B illustrate front and rear views of another embodiment of the holder assembly.

(7) FIGS. 7A and 7B illustrate front and rear perspective views of the holder assembly according to FIGS. 6A and 6B.

(8) FIG. 8 is a front view of an assembly showing internal components of the holder assembly.

(9) FIG. 9 is a front view of another embodiment of the holder assembly.

(10) FIG. 10 is a front view of the embodiment in FIG. 9 with a front portion of a housing thereof removed to show interior components of the assembly.

(11) FIGS. 11A and 11B are front and side perspective views of an embodiment of a receiver plate for the assembly holder.

(12) FIGS. 12A to 12E are various views of adapter pins for use with an adapter plate as illustrated in FIGS. 13A and 13B.

(13) FIG. 13A is a perspective view of an adapter plate for a holder assembly according to any one or more embodiments described herein.

(14) FIG. 13B is a front perspective view of the adapter plate mounted to a holder assembly.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(15) Described herein are attachment devices and methods for transport of accessories wherein the devices and methods implement a receiver plate that can be affixed permanently, semi-permanently, or removably to tactical, or non-tactical clothing items, equipment, or accessories such as backpacks, utility belts, or various other items. While examples discussed throughout this disclosure relate to a device for supporting a firearm thereon, a firearm is merely one non-limiting example, and various other objects and/or accessories may be secured to the receiver plate directly as discussed throughout this disclosure and/or by way of an adapter plate.

(16) The device according to one or more embodiments described herein includes a housing which supports a receiver plate. The receiver plate is moveable, for example, slidable within the housing and the receiver plate is further configured with one or more apertures which receive one or more insertion posts. The receiver plate may also be referred to herein as a capture device or movable capture device. The one or more apertures are spaced apart on a face of the receiver plate. These apertures may be referred to as receiver hitch latching apertures, latching apertures, key hole apertures or the like. The distance between these apertures may correspond to the placement of take-down pins on a specific firearm. Movement of the receiver plate affects locking and unlocking of the insertion posts to the receiver plate, thus securing the insertion posts to the housing. The insertion posts are also concurrently secured to an object or accessory, for example, a firearm.

(17) The insertion posts are configured on a first, terminal end for insertion into a corresponding aperture on the receiver plate and secure thereto by way of latching, clasping, or otherwise grasping by way of a fork, pin, keyhole, or other geometry that results in interference fit between the receiver plate and the insertion post(s).

(18) The housing is provided with apertures that are aligned with the receiver plate apertures as the plate is moveable within its position in the housing. The housing then may be provided one or more guide mechanisms on an external surface of the housing. These guide mechanisms may guide a corresponding one of one or more insertion posts into the corresponding aperture in the receiver plate positioned there below. The insertion post is then guided into connection with an aperture where the receiver plate is in a first position, an “unlocked position.” The receiver plate is then moved to a second position, a locked position, which captures a surface of the insertion pin in the aperture of the receiver plate, thus securely holding the insertion pin therein.

(19) When in the locked position, the posts are received in the corresponding aperture of the receiver plate and are latched, clasped or otherwise grasped by the receiver plate in a manner where movement in and out of the aperture is prevented. Correspondingly, the receiver plate is in an unlocked position when the one or more insertion posts are free to move in and out of the corresponding aperture in the receiver plate.

(20) The receiver plate may be manually moved or slid to one position, for example, the unlocked position. The receiver plate may be held in this unlocked position by way of a locking mechanism which engages with a surface of the housing to retain the receiver plate in the unlocked position. A spring may then be provided operably coupled to and biasing the receiver plate to return the receiver plate automatically to the second position, the locked position. Disengaging the locking

mechanism from the surface of the housing then allows the spring to relax which forces the receiver plate to the locked position.

(21) For example, the locking mechanism comprises a flange, post, plate or other mechanism configured to manually moved with only one digit, for example, the thumb. The flange, post, plate or other mechanism is moveable in reciprocal directions within a corresponding slot or channel. The locking mechanism may be movable in one or more directions. For example, the locking mechanism may move with the receiver plate as an extension of the receiver plate. The locking mechanism may additionally move in an additional direction allowing the locking mechanism to move with the receiver plate as an extension of the receiver plate as well as move towards or away from the surface of housing for engaging and disengaging with the surface of the housing.

(22) It is also contemplated and within the scope of the disclosure that the spring biasing the receiver plate may be positioned in a manner to automatically move the receiver plate to the unlocked position if desired, and require manual force to move the receiver plate to the locked position.

(23) The device described herein provides a means of supporting a device, such as a long gun in conjunction with the equipment vests, ballistic vests, backpacks, and similar wearable items of clothing or accessories. The one or more insertion post(s) may be directly mounted to the firearm by threaded means, or attached with the use of adapter plates, rings, locking cams, and/or combinations thereof to fix the insertion post(s) directly to the firearm or other accessories. The insertion post(s) may also be a component of the firearm itself or a modified version of a firearm component such as a “takedown pin” that is already found within the design of the firearm. The insertion posts may be used in place of standard takedown pins and thus function on the firearm as takedown pins and also act as insertion posts for coupling to the receiver plate and thus mounting the firearm thereto.

(24) A first end of the one or more insertion posts is configured for removably securing to the apertures in the receiver plate such that the one or more posts are removably coupleable to the housing. A second opposing end of the one or more insertion posts is then configured for or otherwise secured to an accessory for securing to the housing. The accessory may be one of various model firearms. In such embodiments, the insertion post(s) comprise take-down pins original to the firearm or extended, modified or re-purposed take-down pins of a firearm. These insertion posts that comprise modified takedown pins may be longer than a standard takedown pin along the shaft of the pin. In one embodiment, the insertion posts may be modified extended take-down pins having a length approximately $\frac{3}{4}$ inches longer than a factory or standard take-down pin. The insertion posts and/or modified posts may further comprise a capture geometry such as an o-ring, retaining ring, retaining pin, bushing, or the like thereon. The capture geometry is positioned on a length of the post (e.g., pin) and may be positioned at a midpoint radial slot. The capture geometry is provided on post and may be connected to the midpoint radial slot of the post and may be provided for the purposes of preventing the post from being driven out of (into) the firearm while the insertion post is also being connected to the device described herein. This capture geometry of the modified insertion post may act as a lock for locking the position of the insertion post on the firearm. Additionally, or alternatively, the insertion posts may be slotted for use with a fork type locking mechanism. The insertion posts may also include holes for retention by pins or similar methods inserted either manually or mechanically therein. Further, the insertion posts may have one or more threaded ends for coupling to internally threaded openings in a firearm or other accessory.

(25) As discussed herein, takedown pins may be the mechanism used to attach the accessory, such as a firearm, to the assembly. In some embodiments the use of takedown pins for insertion pins is dependent upon what type of firearm is used. For example, factory takedown pins may be replaced with the modified takedown pins, which protrude outside of the body of the firearm, giving the pins enough length to feature the geometry necessary to be grasped by the connection guide of the

assembly.

(26) In additional or alternative embodiments, an adapter plate may be provided for coupling to the device. The adapter plate couples to the receiver plate via one or more adapter pins. The adapter plate has a plurality of adapter apertures spaced there along. One or more adapter pins can then be coupled to one or more adapter apertures that align spacing wise with the guide mechanism spacing and thus the apertures in the receiver plate. This allows the adapter plate to lock into connection with the device. Additional apertures in the adapter plate are then usable with pins, fasteners or the like for coupling to an object or accessory for removably mounting the same on the housing. The adapter plate thus can couple to both the housing and an additional object or device, regardless of whether that additional object or device is a firearm or other accessory.

(27) Attachment of the device to wearable clothing items or accessories, either by permanent or removable methods, allows for the direct attachment of firearms such as rifles or other long guns by utilizing attachment equipment designed to fit the common features of the pre-existing firearm. This device effectively bridges the gap between slings commonly used with long guns and holsters which are commonly used with handguns.

(28) The device housing may further be provided with a mounting geometry on a rear or back side of the housing which is configured to mate with a mounting device which can engage with MOLLE PALS strapping or otherwise have a rear surface capable of mounting the user's clothing or equipment.

(29) In one embodiment as illustrated in FIGS. 1-5, a device **10** comprises a housing **12** and a receiver plate **14** movable therein. The housing **12** has a first surface for supporting a firearm and a rear surface which may then abut a user or otherwise contact or couple to the user's clothing or an accessory for mounting the device **10** thereto. In use, the device **10** is secured to a user article or accessory by way of a fixed or a removable attachment to clothing, accessories, backpacks or the like. The device **10** may be removably secured to the user's clothing, accessory or equipment by way of clips, fasteners, straps or combinations thereof.

(30) In further detail, the housing **12** supports one or more connection guides **20** which are configured to guide insertion posts **30** or adapter pins **42** into a corresponding latching aperture **16** of the receiver plate **14**. The housing **12** is provided with apertures **13** that are aligned with the latching apertures **16** of the receiver plate **14**. The latching apertures **16** may be keyholes or other notched openings for securing the insertion posts **30** to the housing **12**. The receiver plate **14** is slidable to secure the insertion post **30** to the housing **12** as discussed in further detail below.

(31) The device **10** may further comprise one or more surfaces **22** for steadying and/or maintaining the firearm in position on the device **10**.

(32) The connection guides **20** may have one or more funneled features to guide the insertion of each insertion post **30** or adapter pin **42** into the latching aperture **16** of the receiver plate **14**. The latching apertures **16** are spaced apart on a surface of the receiver plate **14** and in this embodiment comprise notched slots **16** positioned below each connection guide **20**. The notched slot **16** has a first end, the notch, with a larger opening than provided by the adjoining slot. The connection guide **20** guides a protruding, terminal end of the insertion post **30** or adapter pin **42** into the notch. As the receiver plate **14** is moved in a first direction, the slot is moved to the insertion post **30** to capture and lock the terminal end of the insertion post **30** therein. The receiver plate **14** is slidable in reciprocal directions as shown by arrows **34** such that unlocking the insertion posts comprises moving the receiver plate **14** in the opposite direction to move the notch of the latching aperture **16** to the terminal end of the insertion post **30** so that the insertion post **30** can be removed or disengaged.

(33) The receiver plate **14** is spring biased with a return spring **18** which is secured to the housing **12** on one end in a fixed manner. The spring **18** is also operably coupled to and/or operably in contact with the receiver plate **14**, for example on a second end of the spring **18** to bias or otherwise move the receiver plate **14**. The receiver plate **14** is then manually moveable to a first position

which may be an unlocked position by way of pushing a locking plate **24** along a slot **26** in the housing **12**. When manual force is removed from the locking plate **24**, the spring relaxes and forces automatic return of the receiver plate **14** to a locked position. The locking plate **24** may be a tab or other surface integral to and extending from the receiver plate **14**.

(34) In an additional or alternative embodiment illustrated in FIGS. **6A-8**, the device **10** has a housing **12** with the receiver plate **14** therein. The receiver plate comprises keyhole latching apertures **16** for coupling to insertion posts **30**. The receiver plate **14** is again spring **18** biased wherein the spring **18** resides in a channel **19** inside the housing **12**. The spring **18** biases movement of the receiver plate **14** and thus can be used to automatically return the receiver plate **14** to a locking position. It is possible to move the spring **18** to the opposite side of the receiver plate **14** by moving the spring **18** in the channel **19** and thus offering a selectively ambidextrous device by flipping the receiver plate **14** over or allowing for automatic return of the receiver plate **14** to the unlocked position instead of the locked position. The housing **12** and receiver plate **14** have corresponding openings to allow for movement of the components, including slot **26**.

(35) The locking mechanism **24** is reciprocally displaced along the slot **26**. When the locking mechanism **24** is used, a first end of the locking mechanism **24** engages with a locking surface **32** on the housing **12**. A second spring **28** is provided to bias the locking mechanism in addition to the spring **18** which biases the receiver plate **14**. The spring **18** and second spring **28** are positioned in the housing in perpendicular orientations for effecting different directional movement. The second spring **28** forces the locking mechanism **24** towards and into the locking surface **32** on the housing. At the same time, spring **18** is compressed. Thus, the receiver plate **14** is locked in one position, for example, the open position for the insertion or removal of the insertion posts **30**. Manual force is then required then to disengage the locking mechanism **24** from the locking surface **32** and compress second spring **28** while spring **18** is released which moves the receiver plate **14** accordingly and concurrently, such that the receiver plate **14** is automatically held in another position, for example, the locked position. The second spring **28** is compressed and the end of the locking mechanism rests on a surface of the housing **12**.

(36) A second notch **32** may be provided for an alternative orientation of the device **10**, for example, switching the device between a “right handed” device and a “left-handed” device.

(37) The device **10** may further be provided in smaller dimensions as illustrated in FIGS. **9** to **11B**, such that spacing between latching apertures **16** is reduced and only one locking surface **32** is provided on the housing **12**. It is also contemplated and within the scope of this disclosure that the spacing between the latching apertures may be further increased with respect to the embodiment illustrated.

(38) The device **10** according to one or more embodiments herein may further be provided with mounting geometry **52** on a rear face of the housing **12**. This mounting geometry **52** may be used to couple the device **10** to a mounting device which easily couples to a user's gear or clothing for example. The mounting geometry **52** may comprise a series of apertures and protrusions in selected patterns which couple with reciprocal mounting geometry on clips of other hardware for use.

(39) One or more embodiments of the device **10** described herein may be used with an adapter plate **40** as illustrated in FIGS. **12A-13B**. The adapter plate **40** and adapter pins **42** are illustrated with respect to one non-limiting device **10** configuration. The adapter plate **40** has a length that comprises one or more apertures **50** spaced therealong. The apertures **50** are configured for receiving one or more adapter plate pins **42**. These apertures **50** may also be mounting holes for securely coupling to adapter pins **42**. Additional apertures may then be used with additional fasteners, pins, posts, clips or other mechanisms to couple the adapter plate **40** to an object or accessory which may or may not be a firearm or accessory. Thus, the adapter plate **40** is secured to the device **10** and a second object, device or accessory. The adapter pins **42** also comprise a terminal end **44** which is configured in the manner of an insertion post **30** as described above having a neck or lip which is configured to latch to the slot of the latching aperture **16** of the

receiver plate **14** of any one or more of the embodiments of devices **10** described above. A proximal end **46** of the adapter pin **42** is securable in one of the apertures **50** of the adapter plate **40**.

(40) The coupling of the adapter pins **42** to the receiver plate **14** may be a friction fit, snap fit, releasable fit, or other removably mechanical coupling of surfaces.

(41) As mentioned previously, the insertion posts **30** are coupled to the firearm at a proximal end of the insertion pin while the terminal end of the insertion pins **30** is insertable into the connection guide **20**.

(42) The device **10** may comprise a housing **12** and/or receiver plate **14** according to one or more embodiments herein and which may be made of metal such as steel, titanium or like metals, alloys, composite plastics, carbon fiber or combinations thereof. The insertion posts **30** may be made of metals, alloys, composite plastics, carbon fiber, or combinations thereof. The device, its components and the insertion posts may be constructed from the same or different materials or combinations. Similarly, the adapter plate and/or adapter plate pins may be made of metals, alloys, composite plastics, carbon fibers, or combinations thereof.

(43) Although the present disclosure has been described with reference to preferred embodiments, workers skilled in the art will recognize that changes may be made in form and detail without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure.

Claims

1. A mounting device for a firearm, the mounting device comprising; a housing having two housing apertures; at least two insertion posts; and a capture interface having two spaced apart latching apertures aligned with the two housing apertures and wherein the capture interface is moveable within the housing and the each latching aperture is configured to receive and couple to one of the insertion posts to secure a first end of each insertion post to the mounting device, wherein the housing comprises one or more funneled features extending outwardly therefrom and surrounding each housing aperture for receiving and guiding each insertion post into the corresponding latching aperture on the capture interface, and wherein the insertion posts comprise extended takedown pins for the firearm or are pins of an adapter mounted to the firearm such that the mounting device is configured to support a firearm thereon.
2. The mounting device of claim 1 wherein the capture interface is a spring biased receiver plate wherein the capture interface is moveable between a first position and a second position wherein in the first position first portions of the latching apertures are exposed and configured to receive the first ends of the insertion posts therein and wherein in the second position second portions of the latching apertures are exposed and configured to hold the first ends of the insertion posts therein.
3. The device of claim 2, and further comprising a lever on the housing which is a release lever that is moveable to move the capture interface between the first and second positions.
4. The mounting device of claim 1, wherein the insertion posts are extensions, modifications, or specialized versions of takedown pins for a firearm.
5. The mounting device of claim 4, wherein the takedown pins comprise an o-ring, retaining ring, retaining pin, or bushing.
6. The mounting device of claim 1, wherein second ends of the insertion posts are appendages attached to a firearm, a mounted firearm accessory, or firearm assembly components which have been modified to serve a purpose on the firearm, and as a means of attaching the firearm to the receiver plate.
7. The mounting device of claim 1, wherein the housing is configured for fixedly or removably attaching to clothing, accessories, or backpacks.
8. The device of claim 1, wherein the insertion posts are fixedly or removably attached to available accessory mounting geometry on a firearm or an attachable firearm accessory.
9. The mounting device of claim 1, where the insertion posts are slotted for use with a fork type

locking mechanism.

10. The mounting device of claim 1, where the insertion posts comprise holes for retention by pins inserted either manually or mechanically there through.

11. The mounting device of claim 1, wherein the receiver plate is comprised of metal, alloy, composite plastic, carbon fiber, or combinations thereof.

12. The mounting device of claim 1, wherein the latching apertures comprise one or more latching features that mate with insertion pins, posts, or appendages.
